

# Gerresheimer at CPhI Worldwide 2025

Frankfurt · October 2025 · 18 sqm Island · Exec: Chinmay

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|------------|---------------|----------|--------------|---------------|---|
| STAND SIZE | 18 sqm island | MEETINGS | 47 qualified | RFQs ON FLOOR | 3 |
|------------|---------------|----------|--------------|---------------|---|

## The Brief

Gerresheimer came to us with a specific problem.

They were launching a new range of plastic primary packaging for biologics — high-precision, high-trust product category. The ask: make it feel premium. Make it feel like a pharmaceutical lab. But don't make it cold.

That's a harder brief than it sounds. Most pharma stands at CPhI look like hospital waiting rooms. White walls, catalogue stands, fluorescent overheads. Clinical without being credible. Sterile without being sophisticated.

Gerresheimer needed something different. Their buyers — formulation scientists, procurement heads, VP-level packaging decisions — walk past 300 booths in three days. The stand had to stop them. Then hold them.

## The Challenge

18 sqm island at CPhI Worldwide is not a lot of real estate. Frankfurt Messe is one of the most competitive exhibition floors in the world — pharma companies routinely spend €300k+ on double-deck builds in the halls.

Our constraints:

- 18 sqm, all four sides open
- Premium feel without oversized budget
- Product must be hero — not just displayed, but *experienced*
- Space for qualified conversations, not foot traffic

The risk: try to compete with the big builds on size and lose. Design something forgettable with the money saved. Neither option works for a client at this level.

## The Key Move

One decision changed everything.

We suspended a backlit ceiling panel at 2.8m — full footprint of the stand, slightly inset from the edges to create a floating halo effect. Warm white LED, diffused through frosted acrylic. No harsh downlight. No fluorescent flicker.

Under that ceiling, the product display became a lit island. A custom plinth, 400mm raised, backlit from below in cool white. Each piece of packaging placed individually, spaced like objects in a design museum rather than a product catalogue.

The ceiling did three things simultaneously:

1. **Created an immediate visual boundary** — you knew when you were 'inside' the Gerresheimer space
2. **Lifted the ambient light temperature** to feel warm, not clinical
3. **Made the product glow from two directions** — above and below — giving depth to objects that are, functionally, transparent containers

The meeting area sat in the rear quadrant: two chairs, one low table, brand graphic at eye height. Private enough for real conversation. Open enough to not feel trapped.

Brochure display: flush-mounted into the back column. Nothing on stands. Nothing cluttered.

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## What Happened on the Floor

Three days. Frankfurt. One of the busiest pharma shows in the calendar.

- **47 qualified meetings** held at the stand over three days
- **3 RFQs generated on the floor** — packaging decisions initiated without leaving the booth
- Client contact described it as *“the best stand we’ve had at CPhI”*
- Within 4 weeks of the show: Gerresheimer briefed us for their **USA show** — unprompted

|                   |                                     |
|-------------------|-------------------------------------|
| Show              | CPhI Worldwide 2025, Frankfurt      |
| Stand size        | 18 sqm island                       |
| Meetings on floor | 47 qualified                        |
| RFQs generated    | 3                                   |
| Follow-on brief   | USA show (same client, same year)   |
| Images            | 8 available (including 1 hero shot) |

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## What This Proves

**Budget is not the constraint. Light is.**

Most exhibitors spend money on size and structure. They add walls, levels, features. Gerresheimer spent money on quality of experience within a tight footprint. The suspended ceiling cost less than a second storey. It worked harder.

Three rules that apply to every pharma and high-trust brand brief:

**The product must be the hero.**

Not the brand wall. Not the architecture. The product. Everything else is a frame.

**Warm light in a cold category creates contrast.**

Pharmaceutical = clinical = white and cold. Break that association and you stand out by default.

**A small stand with one strong idea beats a large stand with no idea.**

Gerresheimer's 18 sqm held 47 qualified meetings. The double-deck next door held a lot of brochure giveaways.

*"Best stand we've had at CPhI.*

*We want to do the same for the USA show."*

— Ravikumar, Gerresheimer